

Worksheet — Power-sharing (Class 10 CBSE Civics)

Total marks: **30** · Questions: **11**

Instructions: Attempt all 11 questions. Show your reasoning where required. Total time: 50 minutes.

Q1. Sri Lanka emerged as an independent country in: [1 mark]

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1948
- (C) 1956
- (D) 1972

Q2. In Brussels, French-speakers are about: [1 mark]

- (A) 20%
- (B) 40%
- (C) 59%
- (D) 80%

Q3. Belgium amended its constitution four times between 1970 and 1993. [1 mark]

- (A) True
- (B) False

Q4. In 1956, Sri Lanka recognised _____ as the only official language. [1 mark]

Q5. Power shared among legislature, executive and judiciary is: [1 mark]

- (A) vertical distribution
- (B) horizontal distribution
- (C) community government
- (D) alliance

Q6. Why is 'tyranny of the majority' bad even for the majority itself? [2 marks]

- (A) it is unpopular
- (B) it undermines national unity and brings ruin to the majority too in the long run
- (C) it is illegal
- (D) no reason

Q7. Describe the ethnic composition of Sri Lanka. [3 marks]

Q8. List four key features of Belgium's power-sharing model. [3 marks]

Q9. What is the difference between PRUDENTIAL and MORAL reasons for power-sharing? [3 marks]

Q10. Compare the Belgian and Sri Lankan approaches to managing ethnic diversity. What lessons do they teach about power-sharing? [6 marks]

Q11. 'Power-sharing is the very spirit of democracy.' Discuss this statement with examples of horizontal, vertical, social-group and party power-sharing. [8 marks]

Answer Key

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Q1. Sri Lanka emerged as an independent country in:

Answer: 1948

1948.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-02

Q2. In Brussels, French-speakers are about:

Answer: 80%

Brussels is 80% French-speaking.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-01

Q3. Belgium amended its constitution four times between 1970 and 1993.

Answer: True

Four amendments.

TRUE_FALSE · EASY · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-04

Q4. In 1956, Sri Lanka recognised ____ as the only official language.

Answer: Sinhala

Sinhala-only Act.

FILL_BLANK · EASY · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-03

Q5. Power shared among legislature, executive and judiciary is:

Answer: horizontal distribution

Same level — horizontal.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-06

Q6. Why is 'tyranny of the majority' bad even for the majority itself?

Answer: it undermines national unity and brings ruin to the majority too in the long run

Majoritarianism backfires.

MCQ · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-05

Q7. Describe the ethnic composition of Sri Lanka.

Answer: Sri Lanka has two major social groups: SINHALA-speakers (74%) and TAMIL-speakers (18%). Tamils are further split into Sri Lankan Tamils (13%, native) and Indian Tamils (5%, plantation workers). Most Sinhalese are BUDDHIST; most Tamils are HINDU or MUSLIM. About 7% are CHRISTIANS, drawn from both communities.

Two communities + sub-groups + religions.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-02

Q8. List four key features of Belgium's power-sharing model.

Answer: (i) **EQUAL** Dutch / French ministers in the central government; some laws need majority support of each language group. (ii) **Strong STATE GOVERNMENTS** (Flemish + Walloon) that are **NOT** subordinate to the centre. (iii) **BRUSSELS** has its own government with **EQUAL** representation of both communities. (iv) A '**COMMUNITY GOVERNMENT**' for each language community handles culture, education and language matters.

Four features.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-04

Q9. What is the difference between PRUDENTIAL and MORAL reasons for power-sharing?

Answer: **PRUDENTIAL** reasons stress that power-sharing brings **BETTER OUTCOMES** — it reduces conflict between social groups, prevents violence and ensures political stability. It is based on careful calculation of gains and losses. **MORAL** reasons say that power-sharing is the **VERY SPIRIT** of democracy itself — people have a right to be consulted on how they are governed.

Outcomes vs principles.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-SOC-CIV-PS-05

Q10. Compare the Belgian and Sri Lankan approaches to managing ethnic diversity. What lessons do they teach about power-sharing?

Answer: Both Belgium and Sri Lanka are small countries with sharp ethnic and linguistic divisions, but they took **OPPOSITE** paths. **SRI LANKA** — adopted **MAJORITARIAN** measures: a 1956 Sinhala-only law, preferential job and university policies for Sinhalese, and a constitution that fostered Buddhism. The Tamil minority was alienated; their demand for autonomy was repeatedly denied; by the 1980s they demanded a separate Tamil EELAM. The country slid into a **CIVIL WAR** that ended only in 2009, after thousands of deaths and massive damage. **BELGIUM** — **RECOGNISED** its diversity and amended the constitution four times between 1970 and 1993 to share power: equal Dutch–French ministers in the central government; strong state governments not subordinate to the centre; equal representation in Brussels; and a unique **COMMUNITY GOVERNMENT** for cultural / language matters elected by each language community. The arrangements are complicated, but they have **AVOIDED** civic strife — Brussels even became the EU capital. **LESSONS:** (i) majoritarianism may look attractive in the short run but undermines national unity and hurts the majority too; (ii) carefully designed power-sharing — even if complicated — produces stable democracies; (iii) constitutional and institutional arrangements matter more than slogans of unity.

Two-country comparison.

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Q11. 'Power-sharing is the very spirit of democracy.' Discuss this statement with examples of horizontal, vertical, social-group and party power-sharing.

Answer: Democracy means rule by the people — and the people are not one undivided block but a collection of social groups, regions and interests. So power-sharing is not just one feature of democracy among many; it IS democracy. Without it, an elected government can quickly become tyrannical. There are at least four forms: (i) HORIZONTAL — among legislature, executive and judiciary (checks and balances). E.g. in India the Supreme Court can strike down laws of Parliament; the executive is answerable to the Lok Sabha. (ii) VERTICAL — between Union, State and Local governments, with the Constitution clearly assigning different powers to each. (iii) Among SOCIAL GROUPS — the Belgian Community Government; reserved seats for SCs and STs in Indian assemblies. (iv) Among POLITICAL PARTIES, pressure groups and movements — coalition governments; trade unions and business associations and farmer movements influencing policy. PRUDENTIAL reasons (avoiding conflict, ensuring stability) AND MORAL reasons (people have a right to be consulted) both support power-sharing. Sri Lanka shows what happens when power is hoarded by the majority; Belgium shows what is possible when it is shared.

Concept + four forms + reasons.

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